DATASANJ
ANALYTICS CONSULTANCY

FREE CHECKLIST · FINANCE

Automate Your Month-End

A 20-point checklist for finance leads and business owners who rebuild the same reports by hand every month.

- The 5 stages of an automated month-end
- 20 checks to tick, stage by stage
- A simple way to work out the hours you could save
- What to fix first

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START HERE

Month-end should take hours, not days

In many businesses, month-end means exporting from the accounting system, pasting into Excel, fixing formulas, and checking totals by eye. The numbers arrive late and nobody fully trusts them.

An automated month-end does the same work the same way every time: data loads itself, accounts map to report lines, statements build, totals reconcile, and the pack reaches the right people. One business cut board reporting from **5 days to 3 hours** this way.



Signs your month-end needs automating

- × Reports arrive more than five working days after month-end
- × Totals are checked by eye, or adjusted by hand before meetings
- × Only one person knows how the workbook works
- × Each branch or entity sends its own spreadsheet
- × Leaders ask "which number is right?"

How to use this checklist

- ✓ Tick each of the 20 checks that is true today.
- ✓ Your unticked items in the earliest stage are where to start. Later stages depend on earlier ones.
- ✓ Use the time calculator on page 5 to put a number on the hours involved.

A CLEAN MONTH-END IS ALSO THE FIRST STEP TO AI

The same mapped, reconciled, governed data is what lets Copilot or other AI tools answer finance questions correctly.

1 Data in

Getting the numbers out of your systems

- ☐ Trial balance and transactions load from the accounting system automatically, not by export
- ☐ Other sources (payroll, CRM, bank, spreadsheets) load on the same schedule
- ☐ Loads run unattended, early on the first working day
- ☐ You are alerted if a load fails or a source is missing

2 Mapping

Turning accounts into report lines

- ☐ Every account is mapped to a report line in one table, not in formulas
- ☐ New accounts are flagged automatically until they are mapped
- ☐ Entities and branches use one shared chart of accounts mapping
- ☐ The mapping is documented and owned by finance

3 Statements

Producing the pack

- ☐ Profit and loss, balance sheet and cash flow build themselves from the mapping
- ☐ Budget vs actual and prior year are included automatically
- ☐ Branch or entity views come from the same data, not separate files
- ☐ A cash flow forecast updates with each month's actuals

THE CHECKLIST · STAGES 4–5

4 Reconcile

Proving the numbers

- [ ] Totals reconcile to the general ledger on every refresh
- [ ] Balance sheet balances, and differences are shown, not hidden
- [ ] Large variances are highlighted for comment, not found by scrolling
- [ ] Commentary is captured next to the numbers it explains

5 Distribution

Getting it to the people who decide

- [ ] Leaders open a dashboard or receive a PDF automatically
- [ ] Each person sees only their entity, branch or team
- [ ] The pack is ready within hours of month-end close, not days
- [ ] Someone other than the builder can run it, with written steps

YOUR SCORE

Count your ticks out of 20. **16–20**: largely automated; tighten review and distribution. **8–15**: partly automated; start with your first unticked stage. **0–7**: mostly manual; start with Data in and Mapping, where most of the hours go.

TIME CALCULATOR

How many hours does month-end cost you?

Fill in your own numbers. Most businesses underestimate this because the time is spread across several people.

Task each month	People	Hours each	Total hours
Exporting data from systems			
Copying and reformatting in Excel			
Fixing formulas and mapping new accounts			
Checking totals and reconciling			
Building charts and the board pack			
Answering follow-up questions about the numbers			
Total hours per month			

Hours per year

Total hours per month × 12 = _____

Cost per year

Hours per year × hourly cost of the people involved = $_____

What to fix first

- ✓ **Data in and mapping first.** They usually hold most of the hours and every later stage depends on them.
- ✓ **Reconcile automatically before you add dashboards.** Trust comes from numbers that tie to the ledger.
- ✓ **Write it down.** If only one person can run month-end, it is not automated yet.

> *"This was a great investment ... She is very detailed and able to take what I gave her to create something that will save me hours each month." — Client, nonprofit organisation*



Want your month-end to build itself?

DATASANJ automates month-end reporting with Power BI, Power Query and Microsoft Fabric: statements, budget vs actual, cash flow forecasts and dashboards that match your books. Fixed price, built in your own Microsoft account, and fixed free for 30 days after handover.

Book a free 30-minute call

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